UNION BUDGET 2024-25

BITE



ASHIMA GOYAL
Emeritus Professor, Indira Gandhi Institute of Development Research



AJIT RANADE
Vice Chancellor, Gokhale Institute of Politics and Economics, Pune

BALANCING HIGH GROWTH AND SUSTAINABILITY

Addressing the concerns over jobs, giving a rural push and continuing with the high allocation on capex, even while maintaining a tight leash over finances—the challenges before finance minister Nirmala Sitharaman were many. How did she fare? As part of our BITE (Board of India Today Experts) survey, we ask six top economists what their reading of the Union Budget 2024–25 is, its major thrust areas, and some key measures the FM missed out on

Q. What, according to you, is the main thrust of the Union Budget 2024–25?

▶ **ASHIMA GOYAL:** It has correctly identified and worked on critical bottlenecks that need to be released for India to have sustained high growth. These include raising agricultural productivity and making it climate-proof, creating more infrastructure as well as good jobs, raising the level and amount of job-relevant skills and working with states to improve efficiencies. For real change to happen, it is necessary to get the private sector and states on board. The budget has used some well-designed incentives to do so.

▶ **AJIT RANADE:** The budget's main thrust is on providing incentives for job creation, skilling,